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United States Patent	12398811
Kind Code	B1
Date of Patent	August 26, 2025
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Double piece retainer for compact valve

Abstract

A compact manifold ball valve having a valve body, valve ball, valve stem and two piece retainer system; the valve body including a valve chamber having first and second ends, and a first flow passage intersecting the valve chamber and valve ball. The valve ball can be trunnion supported and include pair of movable seat assemblies that can be used to seal the valve ball to the valve body. A two piece retainer can be used to hold in place the valve components, the two piece retainer including a first section which moves only linearly along with a second retainer piece that is a threaded ring that rotationally locks in place the first section of the two piece retainer. The two pieces of the retainer can be symmetrically located about the centerline of the flow passage of the valve body.

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Appl. No.:	18/679833
Filed:	May 31, 2024

Related U.S. Application Data

continuation parent-doc US 17857231 20220705 US 12000506 20240604 child-doc US 18679833
continuation parent-doc US 16931957 20200717 US 11378190 20220705 child-doc US 17857231
continuation parent-doc US 16113050 20180827 US 10718437 20200721 child-doc US 16931957
continuation parent-doc US 14631970 20150226 US 10060538 20180828 child-doc US 16113050
us-provisional-application US 61946252 20140228

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: F16K5/06 (20060101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC F16K5/0642 (20130101); F16K5/0626 (20130101); F16K5/0689 (20130101); F16K5/06 (20130101); Y10T137/0508 (20150401); Y10T137/6035 (20150401); Y10T137/6041 (20150401)

Field of Classification Search

CPC: F16K (5/0642); F16K (5/0626); F16K (5/0689); F16K (5/06); F16K (27/067); Y10T (137/0508); Y10T (137/6035); Y10T (137/6041)

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4953587	12/1989	Steele	251/315.08	F16K 27/067

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/857,231, filed Jul. 5, 2022 (issuing as U.S. Pat. No. 12,000,506 on Jun. 4, 2024), which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/931,957, filed Jul. 17, 2020 (issued as U.S. Pat. No. 11,378,190 on Jul. 5, 2022), which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/113,050, filed Aug. 27, 2018 (issued as U.S. Pat. No. 10,718,437 on Jul. 21, 2020), which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 14/631,970, filed Feb. 26, 2015 (issued as U.S. Pat. No. 10,060,538 on Aug. 28, 2018), which claims the benefit of U.S. Provisional Patent Application Ser. No. 61/946,252, filed Feb. 28, 2014, all of which applications/patents are incorporated herein by reference and priority to/of such applications is hereby claimed.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

(1) Conventionally available are side entry compact valves including a valve ball having integral opposed trunnions rotating in upper and lower trunnion support plates, which plates are supported by the valve body, with right and left valve seats and seals for sealing, and all of which components are inserted and removed from the valve body via one of the side openings of the valve, and which components are held in place during use with a threaded retainer.

(2) The “compact” nature of compact valves generally results from a short or compact valve body having opposed “open” ends each defining a flange closure seat which is engaged by and establishes sealing with a flange closure which may be defined by a flange of a pipe section of the manifold or other piping assembly. Since no other body closure members are provided, the overall length of the valve body is short and compact as compared with the valve body structures of conventional ball valves. Accordingly, the compact manifold ball valves can be installed in piping

systems such as flow control manifolds in offshore production platforms where minimal space is available.

(3) One example of a type of side entry compact valve is disclosed in U.S. Pat. No. 6,669,171 for a "Compact Manifold Trunnion Ball Valve" which is incorporated herein by reference. The upper and lower trunnion support plates prevent the valve ball from transferring downstream loads to the seals and seats reducing frictional forces between the ball and seals.

(4) However, in conventionally available side entry compact valves generally a single piece retainer is threadably connected to the valve body, wherein such single piece retainer must be rotated relative to both the valve body and the adjacent valve seat with such relative rotation causing wear to the seals between the valve seat and retainer along with the seals between the retainer and valve body.

(5) It has been found that sealing elements in compact valves have a significant risk of becoming excessively worn and/or damaged during valve assembly and/or disassembly. It has been found that relative rotational movement between the valve components and the seals increase the risk of substantial wear and/or damage to the seals.

(6) It would be advantageous to have a retainer both threadably connected to the valve body and concentrically positioned in said body, wherein there is little no relative rotational movement between sealing elements for the valve seat and retainer.

(7) It would be advantageous to have a retainer both threadably connected to the valve body and concentrically positioned in said body, wherein there is little no relative rotational movement between sealing elements for the valve body and retainer.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

(8) One embodiment generally relates to compact ball valves for use in conduit manifold systems. More particularly one embodiment includes a compact manifold ball valve having a valve body, valve ball, and valve stem; the valve body including a valve chamber having first and second ends, and a first flow passage intersecting the valve chamber and valve ball. The valve ball can be trunnion supported with at least one trunnion support element. A pair of movable seat assemblies can be used to seal the valve ball to the valve body. In one embodiment the above referenced components can be held in place during use with a threaded two piece retainer.

(9) In one embodiment the two piece retainer longitudinally holds in place at least one trunnion support element restricting the amount of longitudinal movement of said trunnion support element. In one embodiment two trunnion support elements are longitudinally held in place with restricted to no longitudinal movement allowed.

(10) In one embodiment is provided a retainer which is both threadably connected to the valve body and concentrically positioned in said body includes a sealing portion having little to no relative rotational movement between sealing elements for the valve seat and retainer section during valve assembly.

(11) In one embodiment is provided a two piece retainer which is both threadably connected to the valve body and concentrically positioned in said body, wherein the two piece retainer includes first and second sections, wherein the first section having little to no relative rotational movement between sealing elements for the valve seat and retainer section during valve assembly.

(12) In one embodiment is provided a two piece retainer which is both threadably connected to the valve body and concentrically positioned in said body, wherein the two piece retainer includes first and second sections, wherein the second section is threadably connected to the valve body such that rotation of the second section relative to the valve body causes either tightening or loosening of the first section relative to the valve body.

(13) In one embodiment is provided a two piece retainer including first and second sections, wherein the second section is a ring, and rotational movement of the second section causes linear movement of the second section.

(14) In one embodiment rotational movement of the first section relative to the valve body is

constrained and/or prevented. In one embodiment at least one locking pin rotationally locks the first section relative to the valve body while allowing linear movement of the first section relative to the valve body.

(15) In one embodiment rotational movement of the first section relative to the valve body is constrained and/or prevented while relative linear movement is allowed. In one embodiment the first section includes a detachable sealing element along with at least one locking pin that rotationally locks the first section relative to the valve body while simultaneously allowing linear movement of both the first section and sealing element relative to the valve body.

(16) In one embodiment the first section includes a first detachable sealing element and the valve seat includes a second detachable sealing element. In this embodiment the first section also includes at least one locking pin that rotationally locks the first section relative to the valve body while simultaneously allowing linear movement of the first section (and the first sealing element when attached to the first section) relative to the valve body, along with relative movement between the valve seat (and second sealing element when attached to the valve seat) with respect to the first section. In one embodiment the first sealing element forms a seal between the first section and valve body, while the second sealing element forms a seal between the first section and valve seat.

(17) In one embodiment the first section includes first and second detachable and spaced apart sealing elements, along with at least one locking pin that rotationally locks the first section relative to the valve body while simultaneously allowing linear movement of the first section (and the first and second sealing elements when attached to the first section) relative to the valve body. In one embodiment the first sealing element forms a seal between the first section and valve body, while the second sealing element forms a seal between the first section and valve seat.

(18) In one embodiment the locking pins are have a relatively small shear force where a rotational force exceeding a predefined force will cause the shear pin(s) to shear and allow rotational movement between the first section and valve body.

(19) In one embodiment two locking pins are used which are symmetrically spaced about the first section of the retainer.

(20) In various embodiments at least 50 percent of the longitudinal length of the first retainer section enters the interior portion of the valve body. In various embodiments at least 55, 60, 65, 70, 75, 80, 85, 90, 95, 96, 97, 98, 99, and 100 percent of the first retainer section enters the interior portion of the valve body during assembly. In various embodiments the amount of longitudinal length of the first retainer section entering the valve body during assembly is between about a range of any two of the above referenced percentages.

(21) In various embodiments at least 50 percent of the longitudinal length of the second retainer section enters the interior portion of the valve body. In various embodiments at least 55, 60, 65, 70, 75, 80, 85, 90, 95, 96, 97, 98, 99, and 100 percent of the second retainer section enters the interior portion of the valve body during assembly. In various embodiments the amount of longitudinal length of the second retainer section entering the valve body during assembly is between about a range of any two of the above referenced percentages.

(22) In one embodiment the retainer pins are less than about 3 mm in diameter. In various embodiments the retainer pins are less than about 3, 2.5, 2.0, 1.9, 1.8, 1.7, 1.6, 1.5, 1.4, 1.3, 1.2, 1.1, 1.0, 0.9, 0.7, 0.6, 0.5, 0.4, 0.3, 0.2, and 0.1 mm. In various embodiments the diameters of the retainer pines are between about any two of the diameters specified in this paragraph.

(23) In various embodiments the first retainer section includes a plurality of openings and the valve body includes a plurality of openings which match the plurality of openings for the first retainer section. In various embodiments a plurality of retainer pins can be placed in the plurality of openings to rotationally lock the first retainer section with respect to the valve body.

(24) In various embodiments the second retainer section locks in place the plurality of retainer pins in their respective plurality of openings.

(25) While certain novel features of this invention shown and described below are pointed out in

the annexed claims, the invention is not intended to be limited to the details specified, since a person of ordinary skill in the relevant art will understand that various omissions, modifications, substitutions and changes in the forms and details of the device illustrated and in its operation may be made without departing in any way from the spirit of the present invention. No feature of the invention is critical or essential unless it is expressly stated as being “critical” or “essential.”
(26) The drawings constitute a part of this specification and include exemplary embodiments to the invention, which may be embodied in various forms.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

- (1) For a further understanding of the nature, objects, and advantages of the present invention, reference should be had to the following detailed description, read in conjunction with the following drawings, wherein like reference numerals denote like elements and wherein:
- (2) FIG. 1 is a sectional side view of one embodiment the showing a compact valve body with a two piece retainer holding in position the valve ball and trunnion support elements along with the valve ball seats.
- (3) FIG. 2 is an end view of the compact valve shown in FIG. 1, but all valve components shown in an exploded condition from the second end of the body of the compact valve.
- (4) FIG. 3 is a sectional view of the compact valve shown in FIG. 4 taken along the lines 3-3.
- (5) FIG. 4 is a perspective view of the first retainer section shown in the valve of FIG. 1.
- (6) FIG. 5 is an end view of the first retainer section shown in FIG. 4.
- (7) FIG. 6 is a sectional view of the first retainer section shown in FIGS. 4 and 5, taken along the lines 6-6.
- (8) FIG. 7 is a perspective view of the second retainer section shown in the valve of FIG. 1.
- (9) FIG. 8 is an end view of the second retainer section shown in FIG. 7.
- (10) FIG. 9 is a sectional view of the second retainer section shown in FIGS. 7 and 8, taken along the lines 9-9.
- (11) FIG. 10 is a partially exploded perspective view of the valve of FIG. 1 with the two piece retainer of FIGS. 4 through 9 positioned to be installed in the valve body where the valve ball and seats are already installed in the valve body.
- (12) FIG. 11 is a sectional view of the partially exploded view of the embodiment shown in FIG. 10 taken along with lines 11-11.
- (13) FIGS. 12 through 15 schematically indicate the assembly steps of placement of the first and second retainer sections into the valve body.
- (14) FIG. 12 shows both the first and second retainer sections before placement in the valve body of the compact valve.
- (15) FIG. 13 shows the valve of FIG. 12 where the first retainer section has been partially inserted into the valve body, but the second retainer section has not yet been inserted into the valve body.
- (16) FIG. 14 shows the valve of FIG. 12 where both the first and second retainer sections have been partially inserted into the valve body.
- (17) FIG. 15 shows the valve of FIG. 12 where both the first and second retainer sections have been completely inserted into the valve body.
- (18) FIG. 16 is a perspective view of the valve body taken from the first end of the valve body.
- (19) FIG. 17 is a perspective view of the valve body taken from the second end of the valve body.
- (20) FIG. 18 is a side view of the second end of the valve body.
- (21) FIG. 19 is a sectional view of the valve body taken along the lines 19-19.
- (22) FIG. 20 is a perspective view of the valve ball shown in the valve of FIG. 1.
- (23) FIG. 21 is an end view of the valve ball shown in FIG. 16.

- (24) FIG. 22 is a sectional view of the valve ball in FIGS. 20 and 21, taken along the lines 21-21.
- (25) FIG. 23 is a perspective view of the trunnion support element shown in the valve of FIG. 1;
- (26) FIG. 24 is an end view of the trunnion support element shown in FIG. 23.
- (27) FIG. 25 is a sectional view of the trunnion support element shown in FIGS. 23 and 24, taken along the lines 25-25.
- (28) FIG. 26 is a perspective view of the seat shown in the valve of FIG. 1.
- (29) FIG. 27 is an end view of the seat shown in FIG. 26.
- (30) FIG. 28 is a sectional view of the seat shown in FIGS. 26 and 27, taken along the lines 28-28.
- (31) FIG. 29 is a perspective view of the bonnet shown in the valve of FIG. 1.
- (32) FIG. 30 is an end view of the bonnet shown in FIG. 29.
- (33) FIG. 31 is a sectional view of the bonnet shown in FIGS. 29 and 30, taken along the lines 31-31.
- (34) FIG. 32 is a perspective view of the stem shown in the valve of FIG. 1.
- (35) FIG. 33 is a side view of the stem shown in FIG. 32.
- (36) FIG. 34 is a sectional view of the stem shown in FIGS. 32 and 33, taken along the lines 34-34.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE INVENTION

- (37) Detailed descriptions of one or more preferred embodiments are provided herein. It is to be understood, however, that the present invention may be embodied in various forms. Therefore, specific details disclosed herein are not to be interpreted as limiting, but rather as a basis for the claims and as a representative basis for teaching one skilled in the art to employ the present invention in any appropriate system, structure or manner.
- (38) Overview of Compact Valve With Two Piece Retainer
- (39) FIG. 1 is a sectional side view of one embodiment showing an assembled compact valve body 20 with a two piece retainer 1100 (first 1200 and second 1300 sections) installed in the valve body 20 retaining a valve ball 200 and seats 1000,1000' in the valve body 20. FIG. 2 is an end view of compact valve 10, showing certain valve components in an exploded condition—this end view being taken from the second end 40 of body 20. FIG. 3 is a sectional side view of the compact valve 10 taken along the lines 3-3 generally showing all valve components in an exploded condition.
- (40) FIG. 10 is a partially exploded perspective view of compact valve 10 showing valve body 20 with the two piece retainer 1100 (first 1200 and second 1300 sections) positioned to be installed in the valve body 20 where the valve ball 200 and seats 1000,1000' are already installed in the valve body 20. FIG. 11 is a sectional view through the partially exploded view of the compact valve 10 taken along with lines 11-11.
- (41) In one embodiment compact valve 10 can comprise body 20, valve ball 200, and two piece retainer 1100. Valve ball 200 can be rotatably and sealably connected to body 20. Valve body 20 can include flow passage 60. Valve ball 200 can include flow passage 270. To allow flow through flow passage 60 of valve body 20, flow passage 270 can be aligned, either partially or wholly, with flow passage 60. To restrict or prevent flow through flow passage 60, flow passage 270 can be non-aligned, either partially or wholly, with flow passage 60. Alignment of flow passage 270 can be made by rotating valve ball 200 relative to valve body 20.
- (42) Valve ball 200 can be rotatably supported in body 20 by trunnions 220 and 260. Trunnion 220 can be rotatably connected to trunnion support element 400. Trunnion 260 can be rotatably connected to trunnion support element 450. Valve ball 200 can be operatively connected to stem 500, such as through stem recess 220. Stem recess 230 can have a rectangular cross section, although other types of operably connections can be made such as square, ribbed, or any non-circular shaped recess; or any type of mechanical connection.
- (43) In one embodiment rotating stem 500, such as in the direction of arrow 1500, causes similar rotation of valve ball 200. Stem 500 itself can be rotatably connected to body 20. Trunnion support element 400 can be supported in body 20. Accordingly, although valve ball 200 can rotate relative

to valve body, longitudinal movement (i.e., arrows **1510,1520**) can be restricted and/or prevented depending on the relative amount of longitudinal movement allowable between: valve ball **200** and trunnion support elements **400,450**; and trunnion support elements **400,450** and valve body **20**. It is preferred that longitudinal movement between valve ball **200** and valve body **20** be minimized. It is also preferred that stem **500** be aligned with cylindrical opening **420** of trunnion support element **400** (and cylindrical opening **470** of second trunnion support element **450**) as misalignment can cause difficulty in turning valve ball **200**.

(44) Valve ball **200** can be sealably connected to valve body **20** by means of opposed and biased seats **1000** and **1000'**. Seats **1000** and **1000'** can be supported in valve body **20** and biased toward valve ball **200**, respectively in the directions of arrows **1510** and **1520**. Accordingly, where flow passage **270** of valve ball **200** is rotated 90 degrees in relation to flow passage **60** of valve body **20** (e.g., in direction of arrow **1500**), flow is cut off by the sealing effect of seats **1000** and **1000'**. As the relative rotation between flow passage **270** of valve ball **200** and flow passage **60** of valve body **20** is reduced from 90 ninety degrees, the restriction of flow by valve ball **200** is reduced.

Maximum flow through valve **10** is achieved when flow passage **270** of valve ball **200** is aligned with flow passage **60** of valve body **20** (i.e., when the relative rotation is zero degrees).

(45) Generally two piece retainer **1100** can retain the valve components inside valve body **20**.

FIGS. **4** through **9** show various views of components of the two piece retainer **1100** which is generally comprised of rotationally static first section **1200** and rotating second section **1300**.

(46) FIG. **4** is a perspective view of first retainer section **1200**. FIG. **5** is an end view of the first retainer section **1200**. FIG. **6** is a sectional view of first retainer section **1200** taken along the lines **6-6**. First section **1200** can include first and second shoulders **1250,1260** along with first and second circumferential areas **1252,1262** which accommodate seat **1000**. Preferably, planar surface **1222** on second end limits the amount of longitudinal movement of first **400** and second **450** trunnion support elements which second retainer section **1300** is tightened in valve body **20**. When retainer **1100** is installed in valve body **20**, there exists a defined longitudinal length between planar surface **1222** of second retainer section **1200** and third shoulder **116** of valve body **20** so that trunnion support elements **400, 450** each have a limited defined space to sit in (i.e., the space between planar surface **1222** and third shoulder **116**).

(47) Preferably, a seal is maintained between first retainer section **1200** and valve body **20**, which can be a lip seal. To facilitate this sealing, seal recess **1224** can be provided which can accommodate seals **1044**, which seals can each include a lip seal and back-up ring (the back up ring increasing the sealing pressure rating and resisting extrusion of the lip seal). In one embodiment one or both of the back-up rings can be omitted.

(48) Also preferably, a seal is maintained between first retainer section **1200** and valve seal **1000**, which can be an o-ring type seal. To facilitate this sealing, seal recess **1040** can be provided which can accommodate seals **1042**, which seals can each include an o-ring and back-up ring (the back up ring increasing the sealing pressure rating and resisting extrusion of the o-ring).

(49) FIG. **7** is a perspective view the second retainer section **1300**. FIG. **8** is an end view of second retainer section **1300**. FIG. **9** is a sectional view of second retainer section **1300** taken along the lines **9-9**. Second retainer section can be a threaded ring like section having first end **1310** and second end **1320** with a central opening **1305**. A threaded area **1340** can be used to threadably connect second section **1300** to valve body **20**. A plurality of spaced apart openings **1314** can be used to connect section retainer section **1300** to a tool for tightening or loosening of second retainer section relative to valve body **20**.

(50) Assembly and Disassembly of Valve With Two Piece Retainer

(51) FIG. **1** is a sectional side view of the assembled compact valve **10** using two piece retainer **1100** to hold in place various internal valve components. FIG. **2** is an end view of the compact valve **10**, but all valve components shown in an exploded condition from the second end **40** of valve body **20** of compact valve **10**. FIG. **3** is a sectional view of exploded compact valve **10** taken

along the lines 3-3.

(52) FIGS. **10** through **15** schematically indicate the assembly steps of placement of the retainer **1100**'s first **1200** and second **1300** retainer sections into valve body **20**.

(53) FIG. **10** is a partially exploded perspective view of one embodiment of valve **10** showing compact valve body **20** with the two piece retainer **1100** positioned to be installed in valve body **20** where the valve ball **200**, trunnion support elements **400**, **450**, and seats **1000**, **1000'** are already installed in the valve body **20**. FIG. **11** is a sectional view of the partially exploded view of valve **10** taken along with lines **11-11**.

(54) FIG. **12** shows both the first **1200** and second **1300** retainer sections before placement in valve body **20** of compact valve **10**. Arrow **1400** schematically indicates the longitudinal movement which will occur in retain **1100** for pieces **1200**, **1300**, although second retainer section **1300** which include rotational movement.

(55) First section can include detachable seal **1226** which sits in recess **1224**. Detachable seal **1226** can be a lip type seal. In one embodiment seal **1226** can include an extrusion ring to prevent extrusion of seal **1226**. In one embodiment seal **1226** can be an o-ring type seal.

(56) Seat retainer **1000** section can include detachable seal **1042** which sits in recess **1040**. Detachable seal **1042** can be various conventionally available seals. In one embodiment seal **1042** can include an extrusion ring to prevent extrusion of seal **1042**. In one embodiment seal **1042** can be an o-ring type seal.

(57) FIG. **13** shows valve **10** where first retainer section **1200** has been partially inserted into valve body **20**, but second retainer section **1300** has not yet been inserted into valve body **20**. At this point seal **1226** has not yet made contact with valve body **20**. Seal **1224** is shown in the vicinity of threads **140**. Also at this point seal **1042** of seat **1000** has not yet made contact with first retainer section **1200**. Second retainer section **1300** is shown on the outside of valve body **20**. Arrow **1410** schematically indicates that second retainer section **1300** will be rotated relative to valve body **20**, however, during such rotation in the direction of arrow **1410** first retainer section will remain rotationally fixed relative to valve body **20** (and also relative to valve seat **1000**). Arrow **1400** schematically indicates longitudinal movement of first retainer section **1200** relative to valve body **20** while simultaneously remaining rotationally static relative to valve body **20**. In FIG. **13** is also shown retaining pins **1246**, **1246'** in openings **1247** of first retainer **1200**. Retainer pin **1246** will seat in opening **180** for restricting rotational movement of first retainer section **1200** relative to valve body **20**. Retaining pin **1246'** will seat in opening **182** for restricting rotational movement of first retainer section **1200** relative to valve body **20** (rotational movement schematically indicated by arrow **1410**). However, both retaining pins **1246**, **1246'** allow linear movement of first retainer section **1200** relative to valve body **20** (schematically indicated by arrow **1400**).

(58) FIG. **14** shows valve **10** where both first **1200** and second **1300** retainer sections have been partially inserted into valve body **20**. Threads **1340** of second retainer section **1300** have now engaged threads **140** of valve body. Seal **1226** has engaged surface **132** of valve body **20**. Seal **1042** has engaged surface **1262** of first retainer section **1200**. Both retaining pins **1246**, **1246'** allow linear movement of first retainer section **1200** relative to valve body **20** (schematically indicated by arrow **1400**). Rotational movement (schematically indicated by arrow **1410**) of second retainer section **1300**, with its threads **1340** engaging threads **140** of valve body **20**, will cause second retainer section **1300** to move in the direction of arrow **1400** and push first retainer section **1200** in the direction of arrow **1400**.

(59) FIG. **15** shows valve **10** where both first **1200** and second **1300** retainer sections have been completely inserted into valve body **20**. Continued rotational movement of second retainer section **1300** compared to FIG. **14** (schematically indicated by arrow **1410**), with second retainer **1300** threads **1340** engaging threads **140** of valve body **20**, will cause second retainer section **1300** to continue to also move linearly in the direction of arrow **1400** and continue to push first retainer section **1200** linearly in the direction of arrow **1400**. During the linear pushing by second retainer

section **1300**, first retainer section **1200** moves only linearly (schematically indicated by arrow **1400**) and is rotationally constrained by pins **1246** and **1246'**. In this manner the seals **1226** and **1042** only see relative linear movement and no relative rotational movement. Eventually, second retainer section **1300** will push first retainer section **1200** enough in the direction of arrow **1400** that second end **1220** will contact both first **400** and second **450** trunnion supports locking linearly in place these trunnion support elements with shoulder **116** of valve body **20**.

(60) Disassembly of valve **20** can be performed by rotating second retainer section **1300** in a direction opposite of the rotational direction of arrow **1410**. During disassembly, second retainer section **1200** also is constrained from rotational movement by pins **1246** and **1246'**.

(61) Valve Components

(62) Below various individual components of valve **10** will be reviewed.

(63) FIG. **16** is a perspective view of valve body **20** taken from the first end **30**. FIG. **17** is a perspective view of valve body **20** taken from second end **40**. FIG. **18** is a side view of valve body **20** taken from the second end **40**. FIG. **19** is a sectional view of valve body **20** taken along the lines **19-19**. Valve body can include first end **30** and second end **40**. Flow passage **60** can proceed from first end **30** through second end **40**. Stem **500** can be rotatably connected to valve body **20**. Valve body **20** can include internal chamber **50** where valve ball **200** remains during use. From first end **30** to second end **40**, valve body **20** can include threaded area **140**, second cylindrical area **135**, second shoulder **134**, first cylindrical area **132**, first shoulder **130**, internal bore **50**, shoulder **116**, cylindrical area **112**, shoulder **110**, cylindrical area **102**, cylindrical bore **102**. First and second shoulders **100,110** are found in seat recess **120**. Bonnet recess **80** can be provided for allowing attachment of bonnet **800** to valve body **20**. One or more threaded bores **88** can be provided for fasteners **832**. Openings **834,834'** can be used for inserting a stop pin **836**. Lubrication port **160** and vent/bleeding port **162** can be respectively provided for lubrication fitting **161** and vent/bleeding fitting **163**.

(64) FIGS. **29** through **34** show the components of the valve bonnet **800** and stem **700** assembly.

(65) FIG. **32** is a perspective view of stem **500**. FIG. **33** is a side view of stem **500**. FIG. **34** is a sectional view of stem **500** taken along the lines **34-34**. Stem **500** can comprise shaft **510**, and ball drive element **520**. Ball drive element **520** can include substantially planar drive surface **530**. Circumferential bearing surface **550** can be included for rotatably connecting stem **500** with valve body **20** through stem receptacle **70**. Shaft **510** can include recess **580** for a key **582** which key can be used to operatively connect stem **500** to an actuator.

(66) FIG. **29** is a perspective view of bonnet **800**. FIG. **30** is an end view of bonnet **800**. FIG. **31** is a sectional view of bonnet **800** taken along the lines **31-31**. Bonnet **800** can be used to prevent stem **500** from blowing out of valve body **20**. Bonnet **800** can be connected to valve body **20** through one or more fasteners **832**. Bonnet **800** can include tip **870**. Preferably, a seal is maintained between bonnet **800** and valve body **20**. To facilitate this seal, recess **860** can be provided which can include seal **862** such as an o-ring and back-up ring (the back up ring increasing the sealing pressure rating and resisting extrusion of the o-ring).

(67) FIG. **20** is a perspective view of valve ball **200**. FIG. **21** is an end view of valve ball **200**. FIG. **22** is a sectional view of valve ball **200** taken along the lines **21-21**. Valve ball **200** can be spherically shaped and include top **210**, bottom **250**, and flow passage **270**. Upper spherical surface segment can be located by top **210** and lower spherical surface segment **310** can be located by bottom **250**. Stem recess **230** can be included.

(68) Trunnion **220** can be located on top **210** and can include cylindrical area **222**. Cylindrical area **222** can be rotatably or pivotally connected to trunnion support element **400**. Bearing surface **224** can be substantially planar and slidingly contact first surface **402** of trunnion support element **400**. Preferably, a trunnion shim **404** is provided to act as a bearing surface between bearing area **224** of valve ball **200** and trunnion support element **400**. Also preferably, trunnion bearing **425** is provided between trunnion **220** and trunnion support element **400**. Also preferably, trunnion **220** is prevented

from contacting valve body **20** to prevent wear.

(69) Trunnion **260** can be located on bottom **250** and can include cylindrical area **262**. Cylindrical area **262** can be rotatably or pivotally connected to trunnion support element **450**. Bearing surface **264** can be substantially planar and slidingly contact first surface **452** of trunnion support element **450**. Preferably, a trunnion shim **454** is provided to act as a bearing surface between bearing area **264** of valve ball **200** and trunnion support element **450**. Also preferably, trunnion bearing **475** is provided between trunnion **260** and trunnion support element **450**. Also preferably, trunnion **260** is prevented from contacting valve body **20** to prevent wear.

(70) Upper and lower spherical segments **300,310** can each be sealably connected to both seats **1000,1000'**.

(71) FIG. **23** is a perspective view of trunnion support element **400** shown in the valve of FIG. **1**. FIG. **24** is an end view of trunnion support element **400**. FIG. **25** is a sectional view of trunnion support element **400**, taken along the lines **25-25**. Trunnion support element **450** can be substantially similar to trunnion support element **400** and will not be described separately. Cylindrical opening **420** can be provided to slidably connect upper trunnion **220** of valve ball **200**. First and third sides **416,418** of trunnion support element **400** can be held in place between third shoulder **116** of valve body **20** and second end **1220** of first retainer section **1200** (limiting movement of trunnion support element **400** in the direction of arrows **1510,1520**).

(72) FIG. **26** is a perspective view of **1000**. FIG. **27** is an end view of seat **1000**. FIG. **28** is a sectional view of seat **1000** taken along the lines **28-28**. Seat **1000'** can be constructed substantially similar to seat **1000** (and seat **1000'** will not be individually described). Seat **1000** can include internal passage **1010**, first side **1020**, second side **1030**, along with first and second circumferential areas **1070,1080**. First and second circumferential areas **1070, 1080** of seat **1000** sit respectively in first and second circumferential areas **1252,1262** of retainer **1200**. (For seat **1000'**, first and second circumferential areas **1070,1080** sit respectively in cylindrical areas **112,102** of valve body **20**).

(73) Preferably, a seal is maintained between seat **1000** and valve body **20** (or second retainer section **1200**). To facilitate this seal, recess **1040** can be provided which can include seal **1042**, which seal can each include an o-ring and back-up ring (the back up ring increasing the sealing pressure rating and resisting extrusion of the o-ring). Preferably, a seal is maintained between seat **1000** and valve ball **200**. To facilitate this seal, recess **1050** can be provided which can include seal **1052**, which seal **1052** seals with upper and lower spherical surfaces **300,310** of valve ball **200** (seat **1000'** is substantially the same). Seal **1052** can be installed in recess **1050** using any conventional means, such as crimping, adhesive, friction fit, or other means.

(74) To facilitate sealing at lower line pressures between seats **1000,1000'** and valve ball **200**, biasing members **1090,1090'** can be provided which respectively push seat **1000** in the direction of arrow **1520** and seat **1000'** in the direction of arrow **1510** (both seats toward valve ball **200**). At higher line pressures seats **1000,1000'** will tend to be pushed toward valve ball **200** because the larger exposed surface area on first side **1020** as opposed to second side **1030**. This is because line fluid will not be able to pass seal **1052** thereby limiting the amount of surface area to which the line fluid can assert pressure. In an alternative embodiment a second set of biasing members can be provided for second circumferential area **1080** (or area **1080'** for seat **1000'**). In one embodiment, peripheral groove **1082** can be provided to reduce the amount of surface area of seat **1000** which contacts valve body **20** (or retainer **1200** for seat **1000'**) thereby reducing frictional forces between these items.

(75) In any of the embodiments a lip seal can be used as the sealing element. In any of the embodiments an extrusion ring can be used in combination with the lip seal.

(76) The following is a list of reference numerals:

(77) TABLE-US-00001 LIST FOR REFERENCE NUMERALS (Reference No.) (Description) 10 compact manifold ball valve 20 body 30 first end 38 bores for fasteners 40 second end 42 raised

area 44 peripheral groove for seal 46 seal 48 bores for fasteners 50 internal chamber 60 flow passage 70 stem receptacle 72 bore 80 bonnet recess 88 bores for fasteners 90 seat recess 100 first shoulder 102 cylindrical area 110 second shoulder 112 cylindrical area 116 third shoulder 118 cylindrical area 120 seat recess 130 first shoulder 132 cylindrical area 134 second shoulder 135 cylindrical area 138 third shoulder 139 cylindrical area 140 threaded area 150 internal bore 152 cylindrical area 160 lubrication port 161 lubrication fitting 162 vent/bleeding port 163 vent/bleeding fitting 180 opening 182 opening 200 valve ball 210 top 220 trunnion 222 cylindrical area 224 bearing area 230 recess for stem 250 bottom 260 trunnion 262 cylindrical area 264 bearing area 270 flow passage 280 first end 290 second end 300 spherical surface segment 310 spherical surface segment 400 first trunnion support element 402 first surface 404 trunnion bearing 405 trunnion shim/bearing 410 second surface 416 first side 417 second side 418 third side 419 fourth side 420 cylindrical opening 425 trunnion bearing 430 recessed area 450 second trunnion support element 452 first surface 454 trunnion bearing 455 trunnion shim/bearing 460 second surface 466 first side 467 second side 468 third side 469 fourth side 470 cylindrical opening 475 trunnion bearing 480 recessed area 500 stem 510 shaft 520 ball drive element 530 substantially planar drive surface 540 tip 550 bearing surface 552 bearing 570 top 580 recess for key 582 key 800 bonnet 810 first end 820 second end 830 plurality of recessed bores 832 plurality of fasteners 833 plurality of caps 834 opening for stop pin 836 stop pin 840 opening 850 recess 852 seal 860 recess 862 seal 870 tip 880 flat area 890 bore for stop pin 892 stop pin 894 grease bore 896 lubrication fitting 1000 seat 1010 internal passage 1020 first side 1022 planar surface 1030 second side 1032 shoulder 1040 recess 1042 seal and extrusion ring 1044 seal and extrusion ring 1052 seal or face seal 1090 circular wave spring 1100 two piece retainer 1200 first piece of retainer 1210 first end 1212 planar surface 1214 first recessed area 1220 second end 1222 planar surface 1224 seal recess 1226 seal 1230 internal passage 1242 first end 1244 second end 1246 plurality of shearable retainers to restrict rotation 1247 plurality of openings 1248 peripheral edge 1250 first shoulder 1252 first circumferential area 1260 second shoulder 1262 second circumferential area 1270 third shoulder 1272 third circumferential area 1300 second piece of retainer 1305 opening 1310 first end 1314 plurality of openings 1320 second end 1330 internal passage 1340 threaded area 1400 arrow 1410 arrow 1500 arrow 1510 arrow 1520 arrow

(78) All measurements disclosed herein are at standard temperature and pressure, at sea level on Earth, unless indicated otherwise. All materials used or intended to be used in a human being are biocompatible, unless indicated otherwise.

(79) It will be understood that each of the elements described above, or two or more together may also find a useful application in other types of methods differing from the type described above. Without further analysis, the foregoing will so fully reveal the gist of the present invention that others can, by applying current knowledge, readily adapt it for various applications without omitting features that, from the standpoint of prior art, fairly constitute essential characteristics of the generic or specific aspects of this invention set forth in the appended claims. The foregoing embodiments are presented by way of example only; the scope of the present invention is to be limited only by the following claims.

Claims

1. A compact manifold ball valve, comprising: (a) a valve body, the valve body having first and second ends, a valve passage having a longitudinal axis; (b) a valve stem, the valve stem being rotatably operatively to the valve body; (c) a valve ball, the valve ball being located in the valve passage, the valve ball having an upper end, lower end, and flow passage, and a pair of trunnions; (d) a pair of trunnion support plates, the pair of trunnion support plates being located in the valve chamber and rotatably connected to the pair of trunnions; (e) a two piece retainer, the two piece retainer being detachably connected to the valve body and limiting an amount of longitudinal

movement of at least one of the pair of trunnion support plates; (f) the two piece retainer having first and second sections, the first section being sized and shaped to be installed in the valve passage with a generally longitudinal movement, the first section having a first annular face that engages both of said pair of trunnion support plates and a first annular surface spaced from said first annular face, wherein the first section is connected to the valve body such that the first section is prevented from rotating relative to the valve body; (g) the second section being a ring member being detachably connected into the valve passage of the valve body forming a detachable connection; (h) wherein the second section is positioned to push on the first section responsive to a formation of said detachable connection of the ring member to the valve body; (i) wherein rotation of the second section relative to the valve body enables selective tightening or loosening of the first section relative to the valve body; (j) wherein the second section is a ring, and rotational movement of the second section causes linear movement of the second section relative to the valve body; (k) wherein rotational movement of the first section of the two piece retainer relative to the valve body is constrained; and (l) wherein at least one locking pin between the first section and the valve body rotationally locks the first section relative to the valve body while allowing linear movement of the first section relative to the valve body, and the second section is in direct contact with the at least one locking pin.

2. The compact manifold ball valve of claim 1, wherein rotational movement of the first section relative to the valve body is prevented by a plurality of locking pins between the first section and the valve body, while relative linear movement is allowed between the first section and the valve body.

3. The compact manifold ball valve of claim 1, wherein the first section includes a detachable sealing element along with the at least one locking pin between the first section and the valve body rotationally locks the first section relative to the valve body while simultaneously allowing linear movement of both the first section and the detachable sealing element relative to the valve body.

4. The compact manifold ball valve of claim 1, wherein the first section includes a first detachable sealing element which fluidly seals the first section to the valve body.

5. The compact manifold ball valve of claim 4, wherein the first and second detachable sealing elements are spaced apart and attached to the first section, and the at least one locking pin rotationally locks the first section relative to the valve body while simultaneously allowing linear movement of the first section and the attached first and second detachable sealing elements relative to the valve body.

6. The compact manifold ball valve of claim 4, wherein the at least one locking pin rotationally locks the first section relative to the valve body while simultaneously allowing linear movement of the first section and the first detachable sealing element relative to the valve body, along with relative movement between the first section and the second detachable sealing element attached to the first valve seat with respect to the first section.

7. The compact manifold ball valve of claim 6, wherein the at least one locking pin between the first section and the valve body has a predefined shearing force where a rotational force exceeding the predefined shearing force will cause the at least one locking pin to shear and allow relative rotational movement between the first section and valve body.

8. The compact manifold ball valve of claim 1, further including first and second valve seats, wherein the first valve seat is operatively connected to a first biasing member and the second valve seat is operatively connected to a second biasing member, wherein the first and second biasing members respectively bias their respective valve seat to maintain contact with the valve ball.

9. The compact manifold ball valve of claim 8, wherein the two piece retainer longitudinally holds in place at least one of the pair of trunnion support plates restricting the amount of longitudinal movement of said at least one of said pair of trunnion support plates.

10. The compact manifold ball valve of claim 9, wherein the two piece retainer longitudinally holds in place both of said pair of trunnion support plates such that no longitudinal movement is allowed.

11. The compact manifold ball valve of claim 9, wherein the first section includes a sealing portion having no relative rotational movement between sealing elements for the first valve seat during relative movement between the first section and first valve seat during valve assembly, and little to no relative rotational movement between sealing elements for the valve body and two piece retainer during relative movement between the first section and valve body during valve assembly.
12. The compact manifold ball valve of claim 9, wherein the first section includes a sealing portion having no relative rotational movement between sealing elements for the first valve seat during relative movement between the first section and first valve seat during valve assembly.
13. The compact manifold ball valve of claim 12, wherein the second section is both detachably connected to the valve body and concentrically positioned in said valve body relative to said longitudinal axis.
14. A compact manifold ball valve, comprising: (a) a valve body, the valve body having first and second ends, a valve passage having a longitudinal axis; (b) a valve stem, the valve stem being rotatably connected to the valve body; (c) a valve ball, the valve ball being located in the valve passage, the valve ball having an upper end, lower end, and flow passage, and a pair of trunnions, wherein the valve ball is connected to and rotates with the stem; (d) a pair of spaced apart trunnion support plates being located in the valve chamber and rotatably connected to the pair of trunnions; (e) a two piece retainer being detachably connected to the valve body and limiting the amount of longitudinal movement of the pair of spaced apart trunnion support plates; (f) the two piece retainer having first and second sections, the first section being sized and shaped to be installed in the valve passage, the first section having a first annular face that engages both of said pair of spaced apart trunnion support plates and an annular surface spaced from said first annular face, wherein the first section is connected to the valve body such that the first section is prevented from rotating relative to the valve body; (g) the second section being a ring member detachably connectable into the valve passage of the valve body and forming a detachable connection with the valve body; (h) wherein the second section is positioned to push on the first section responsive to a formation of said detachable connection; and (i) wherein rotation of the second section relative to the said valve body enables selective tightening or loosening of the first section relative to the said valve body, and the first section includes at least one locking pin spanning between the first section and the valve body, and the second section is in contact with the at least one locking pin.
15. The compact manifold ball valve of claim 14, wherein the first section includes a sealing portion having no relative rotational movement between sealing elements for a first valve seat during relative movement between the first section and first valve seat during valve assembly, and little to no relative rotational movement between sealing elements for the valve body and two piece retainer during relative movement between the first section and valve body during valve assembly.
16. The compact manifold ball valve of claim 14, wherein the second section is a ring, and rotational movement of the second section causes linear movement of the second section relative to the valve body.
17. The compact manifold ball valve of claim 14, wherein the at least one locking pin rotationally locks the first section relative to the valve body by a plurality of locking pins between the first section and the valve body, while allowing linear movement of the first section relative to the valve body.
18. The compact manifold ball valve of claim 14, wherein the at least one locking pin between the first section and the valve body has a predefined shearing force where a rotational force exceeding the predefined shearing force will cause the said at least one locking pin to shear and allow relative rotational movement between the first section and valve body.
19. The compact manifold ball valve of claim 14, wherein the first section includes a detachable sealing element along with the at least one locking pin between the first section and the valve body that rotationally locks the first section relative to the valve body while simultaneously allowing linear movement of both the first section and the detachable sealing element relative to the valve

body.

20. The compact manifold ball valve of claim 14, wherein the at least one locking pin rotationally locks the first section relative to the valve body while simultaneously allowing linear movement of the first section and a first sealing element relative to the valve body, along with relative movement between the first section and a second sealing element attached to the first valve seat with respect to the first section.
